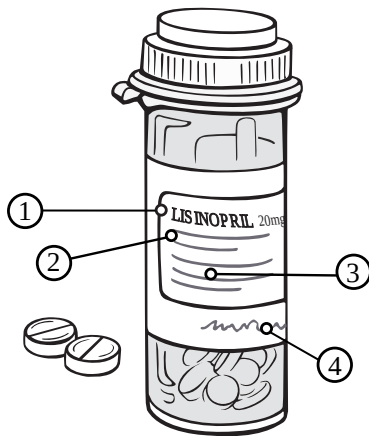


Managing your medicines

This handout tells you how to manage your medicines to take them safely and get the most out of them. Choose the tips that you think will work best for you.

Know your medicines.

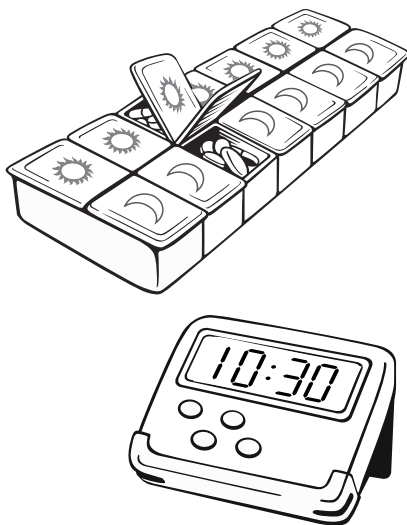


- Know what each medicine does (for example, lowers blood pressure).
- Keep track of how each medicine looks (for example, white tablet).

Read the label on the medicine bottle to find out important information:

1. Name and strength of medicine (for example, Lisinopril 20 mg)
2. When you should take it (for example, once a day in the morning)
3. How you should take it (for example, with water)
4. Doctor who prescribed it

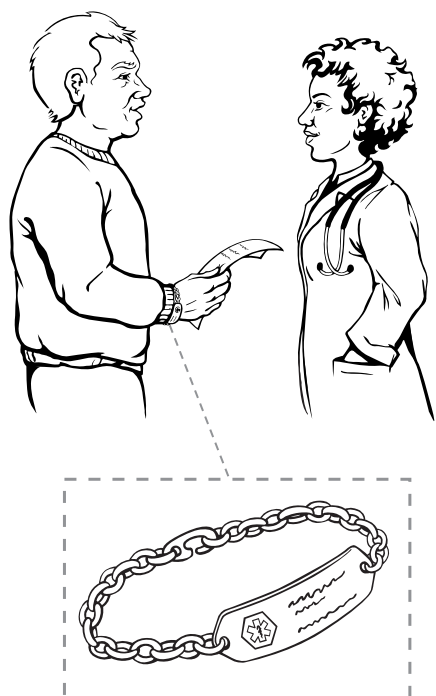
Keep track of your medicines.



Take your medicines at the right times.

- Fill a pill box with the medicines you need for the week.
- Keep your medicines in the original bottles until you put them in the pill box.
- Take your medicines at the same time every day. Use a chart, calendar, or timer to help you remember.

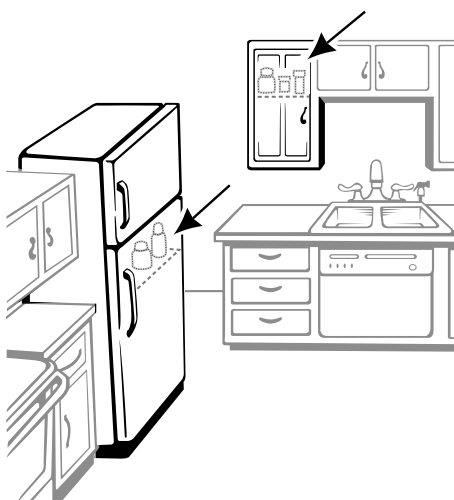
Avoid problems with your medicines.



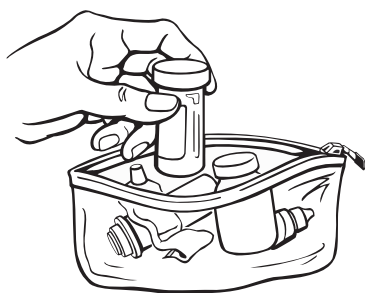
- Make a list of all the medicines you take.
 - Include vitamins, herbs, and all the medicines you buy at the grocery or drug store.
 - Make changes to the list whenever your medicines change. Carry a copy of the list in your wallet.
 - Give your list to all your doctors, dentists, and pharmacists.
- Ask your doctor or pharmacist what you should do if you miss a dose. Find out about the side effects for each of your medicines and which ones are serious.
- Do not stop taking your medicines without first talking to your doctor. Re-order in plenty of time so you do not run out.
- Use one pharmacy for all your prescriptions. Get a 3 month supply if you can. Sign up to have medicines you take regularly filled automatically.
- Check with your doctor or pharmacist before taking any vitamins, herbs, or medicines you buy at the grocery or drug store.
- Never share your medicines with anyone else. Never take someone else's medicine.
- Ask your doctor if you should carry an ID card or wear an alert bracelet for any of your medicines.

- Your doctor may give you a medicine called naloxone. It will help you if you take too much pain medicine by mistake. Tell someone where you keep it and how to use it.
-

Store your medicines safely.



- Keep medicines out of the reach of children.
 - Keep your medicines in a cool dry place where you can find them easily. Store medicines in the refrigerator if the label says to.
 - Do not store pills or capsules in the bathroom or next to the stove.
-



- Have a box or container for each person in your house. Label the box or container with the name of the person in large bold letters.
 - Place that person's medicines in the original bottle in the box. Put them in the order that they are taken each day.
 - Write on the cap with a permanent marker which medicines are to be taken with water, with food, or on an empty stomach. You could also write on the cap what you should not take your medicine with, like NO MILK.
 - Use a plastic cup in the medicine cabinet to hold small tubes of creams, balms, or topical ointments like antibiotics.
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- Bring medicines you need during the day with you when you go out. When traveling, put medicines in your carry-on bags, not in checked luggage.
-

Dispose of your medicines properly.



- Clean out the medicine cabinet at least once a year.
 - Remove all medicines that have expired dates. Include medicines in tubes and medicines you bought at the grocery or drug store that were not ordered by your doctor.
 - Remove all medicines that you no longer take.
-

Check with your pharmacist about a local take-back program. If you have one in your area, take your expired medicines there.

If no medicine take-back program is in your area, follow these steps to dispose of most medicines:

1. Mix medicines (do not crush tablets or capsules) with something that tastes bad, like kitty litter or coffee grounds.
 2. Place the mixture in a sealed plastic bag.
 3. Throw the bag in your trash.
 4. Do not put pain medicines in this bag or in your trash. Pain medicines should be flushed down the toilet or sink to make sure no person or animal swallows the medicine by mistake.
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This information is general in nature and may not apply to you or your condition. Talk to your doctor or nurse about how to best use this information and how to take care of your medical condition. Be sure to ask your doctor or nurse any questions you might have. This information sheet is not intended to provide or replace professional medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment.

Patient or Caregiver:

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Nurse:

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Medicine List

Name: _____

[illegible]